still negotiating for a fresh lot of *pracharaks* to fill the general secretary (organisation) posts at the national level and in the states. Eight states, including poll-bound Uttarakhand, have vacancies.

The reset is on. Saudan Singh, a full-time RSS pracharak on loan to the BJP, returns as joint general secretary (organisation), the post he held till December 2020, when he was shifted to Chandigarh and the tier was left with a single occupant, Shiv Prakash. He has now been roped back in alongside Prakash, with B.L. Santhosh leading the pack as general secretary (organisation). Party insiders offer two readings. Either the leadership is positioning the veteran pracharak to succeed Santhosh, or it is seating a counterweight next to a general secretary whose stand on decisions had become unyielding.

HEMANG JOSHI TAKES OVER THE YUVA MORCHA AND HAS HIS WORK CUT OUT: BRIDGING THE CHASM CREATED BY THE RECENT GEN Z PROTESTS

The second lesson concerns the party base. The Opposition's Constitution-and-reservations-under-attack campaign had moved through OBC, Dalit and farmer constituencies faster than the party could counter. The response: every BJP morcha covering these groups has changed hands. Amarpal Maurya, a Rajya Sabha member from UP, takes over the OBC Morcha. The SC Morcha goes to Shivesh Kumar Ram, a close confidant of Nabin who entered the Rajya Sabha from Bihar in the same round as the president himself. Mannalal Rawat, the Udaipur MP who has a doctorate on tribal issues, gets the ST Morcha. The minorities are now the concern of Kunwar Basit Ali, a young Muslim Rajput leader from Meerut. Roop Kumari Choudhary, an MP from Mahasamund in Chhattisgarh, heads the Mahila Morcha; Rajya Sabha MP Bansilal Gurjar of Madhya Pradesh has been elevated from vice president to head the Kisan Morcha; and Hemang Joshi, a first-term MP from Vadodara, takes over the Yuva Morcha from Surya. Joshi has a big job on his hands—bridging the chasm that became visible during the recent Gen Z protests.

The third lesson concerns narrative, and it is the one the party has absorbed most reluctantly. Malviya's removal comes three weeks after the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) became the organising vehicle for nationwide student protests over the NEET exam paper leaks. The BJP's own posts were flooded with comments demanding Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation; he left the cabinet on July 25. Weeks earlier, the withdrawal of the movie *Satluj* had left the party defending a decision in poll-bound Punjab rather than framing the argument. In both episodes, the BJP, which had built the first mass digital operation in Indian politics and held the advantage for 12 years, was left answering a narrative set by someone else.

Deepak Mhaskey, who replaces Malviya as social media head, rose through the Chhattisgarh unit as its spokesperson and ran the state's digital campaigns. He and Nabin had worked together

INSIDE THE CONTROL ROOM

Forty-two of the 64 office-bearers are below the age of 60. Nabin's team also has the largest presence of women ever

CORE TEAM

Nitin Nabin, *45*
National president

B.L. Santhosh, *58*
General secretary (organisation)

Shiv Prakash, *58*
Joint general secretary (organisation)

Saudan Singh, *65*
Joint general secretary (organisation)



Smriti Irani, *50*
National general secretary

Vinod Tawde, *63*
National general secretary

Sunil Bansal, *56*
National general secretary

Biplab Kumar Deb, *54*
National general secretary

Satish Poonia , *61*
National general secretary

Gajendra Patel, *51*
National general secretary

Harish Dwivedi, *52*
National general secretary

Sanjay Bhatia, *58*
National general secretary

Baijayant Jay Panda, *62*
National vice-president

Tarun Chugh, *53*
Central Office In-charge

SHE POWER

Vasundhara Raje Scindia, *73*
National vice-president

D. Purandeshwari, *66*
National vice-president

S. Phangnon Konyak, *48*
National secretary

Kavita Patidar, *46*
National secretary

